



DRAMA QUEEN
Jayalalitha Jayaram
1988

When Tamil Nadu chief minister M.G. Ramachandran (MGR) died on December 24, 1987, Jayalalitha stood mournfully by his body for 21 hours. In an interview to *INDIA TODAY* in 1988, she said: "When Anna died, MGR was the treasurer of DMK, number four in the party. Now without MGR, as party propaganda secretary, I'm number five."
PHOTOGRAPH BY: SHYAM TEKWANI

MAYA MEMSAAB
Mayawati
1997

When Bahujan Samaj Party, then led by her mentor Kanshi Ram, became a major power player in Uttar Pradesh politics for the first time, *INDIA TODAY* wrote in 1994: "The question now is can he really last to change the social and political agenda?" With the Dalit politician, seen here with late Kanshi Ram, now firmly ensconced, we have the answer.
PHOTOGRAPH BY: DILIP BANERJI

